Muncie Policy Memo

Civic Meeting Report

11/10/2026 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iFET0MK2UZk
Publication Date	2026-11-10 00:00:00
Target Category	mcs

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Muncie Community Schools Board of Trustees
Date: November 11, 2024 (Implied by Veterans Day references)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the meeting to order at 5:00 PM 00:02:43, followed by a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance.
- **Attendance:**
  - **Present:** Dr. O'Neil, Mrs. Barnes-Griffin, Dr. Washburn, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Lowe.
  - **Absent:** Mr. Heater (noted as out of the country).
  - **Presiding Officer:** Identified through leadership of roll call and proceedings (Dr. O'Neil / Board President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opened with a moment of silence and the Pledge of Allegiance 00:02:46–00:03:09.
- **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text beyond standard opening proceedings.)*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:29:45 Consent Agenda & Donations

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board / Administration.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The board recognized several generous community donations, including:
  - North Side High School class donation to North Side Athletics.
  - Exchange Club of Muncie donation to Muncie Central High School ROTC.
  - Donations to Panther Pantry from Randy Thompson, Lanny Wilson, and Jim Shreckengost.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:30:30.

00:30:45 Financial Report (October 2024)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome (Chief Financial Officer / Financial Staff).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
  - Reported receipt of the state basic grant for October, noting that the slight increase in ADM enrollment count (up 16 students to 4,860) will reflect in November and December revenues.
  - Headcount is down 31 employees compared to the previous year, driven largely by attrition, resulting in weekly payroll running nearly $100,00 less than the prior year.
  - Cash balance stood at a little over $31 million for October, which includes $6 million in bond proceeds received on October 1st for upcoming summer construction work ($14 million spent on bond projects year-to-date).
  - Education fund balance sits at $14.9 million. The state-based $12 million loan is reduced to $4.1 million (over $7.8 million paid back).
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:37:05.

00:37:10 Year-End Budget Transfers & Rainy Day Fund Authorization

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad (Financial Staff).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Requested formal board permission to make necessary year-end internal line-item transfers within the education fund (ensuring total approved budget limits are not exceeded) and authorization to transfer up to $1 million into the rainy day fund before the end of the calendar year.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:38:25.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: No traditional open public comment period or citizen speakers addressed the board during the designated public participation slot; however, school presentations and reports featured extensive commentary from staff, administrators, and student partners.)

- 00:08:49 **Mr. Ryan Nason (South View Assistant Principal):** Highlighted academic gains on state testing across the board, targeted writing and math intervention strategies, and increased scorable writing pieces.
- 00:15:16 **Vivica Watkins (South View Third Grade Teacher):** Shared information regarding CCLA and STEM integration in the third-grade classroom, including human body and ecology projects.
- 00:16:41 **Alana Trimble (Ivy Tech Early Childhood Education Student / Cowan High School Senior):** Shared her positive student apprenticeship experience at South View Elementary and how working with students shifted her career goals toward becoming a teacher.
- 00:18:54 **South View Administrative & Teaching Staff (including Amy Heath):** Discussed community partnerships involving Ball State University, Ivy Tech, First Presbyterian Church, and local volunteers providing one-on-one tutoring and science "mystery festivals."

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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
  - **Superintendent Update (00:03:44):** Dr. Reynolds highlighted a CBS 4 / Channel 59 news segment on Forest Academy at Camp Adventure, upcoming Veterans Day programs across district schools, winter sports kickoffs, the upcoming 90th Annual Community Sing on December 6th at the Field House, Department of Education visits regarding science of reading instruction, and the Muncie Central football team's first sectional championship in 20 years with a community send-off scheduled for Friday at 3:00 PM.
  - **Field House Status (00:38:34):** Administration provided an update on the Muncie Field House, noting that Miller Pipeline and Vector Energy are scheduled to install gas lines for boiler hookup, aiming to restore heat within approximately 5 days. A temporary certificate of occupancy has been granted for basketball practices using the east gym entrance and restrooms.
  - **Ball State Centennial Celebration (00:40:58):** Discussed ongoing collaboration with Ball State University on an immersive learning project leading up to the Muncie Field House 100-year celebration in 2028.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially motioned, seconded, and **Approved by Voice Vote** to adjourn 00:44:21.

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